

THE MISSING SUN

The sun goes out, the world goes dark, and the most confident detective in history is handed the case. The problem: he did it. He just doesn't remember.

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Team Zenitsu · Godot 4.7 / GDScript · First-person comedy mystery · General Track, 100-hour jam

Repo: <https://github.com/ramavathramteja-web/game-2026/tree/main>

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01 Concept

The sun disappears. Not sets — disappears. Every clock stops at 9:14 a.m., the sky closes to black, and the whole planet is left lit by nothing but whatever people still have switched on.

You are **Detective Ray**: extremely confident, spectacularly unqualified, and the only officer left on the force. Your case file is one line long — FIND OUT WHO TURNED OFF THE SUN.

The suspects are all extremely stupid, and every one of them is telling the truth, which is somehow worse. The **Moon** claims it was simply doing its job. The **Clouds** are suspiciously still. The **Talking Lamp** insists it saw everything. The **Suspicious Toaster** refuses to answer questions. The **Villain** keeps saying “I DIDN’T DO IT.” And in the tutorial area, where you learn to walk and look, there is a switch that has no business being there.

The twist: every clue points somewhere sensible. Then the Sun Control Room shows you the access log, and it is in your own handwriting, from a switch you don’t remember flipping.

Unifying rule: the light is the mechanic, the mood and the punchline — every puzzle is a joke about not seeing clearly, every clue is something a lamp found before you did, and the only thing the case ever withholds from you is a straight answer.

02 The Three Themes

COMIC — suspects with no alibi and no plan

Ridiculous suspects, not villains. Nobody is lying — they simply hold wildly different definitions of the truth. Dialogue escalates on what you already know, so re-questioning the Lamp once you hold a clue is an entirely different conversation than the first time.

LIGHT — the mechanic, not the mood

The world is genuinely dark and the flashlight is your first tool. Lamps, switches and mirrors route light through the puzzles — anything you cannot see, you cannot touch. Bright cartoon rendering, never horror.

TWIST — every clue is true, the conclusion isn’t

Each suspect’s evidence is internally consistent and individually convincing. The final evidence is not a new clue — it is the absence of one, and the last puzzle is the tutorial, replayed, now legible.

EXPLORE → CLUE → QUESTION → PUZZLE → EVIDENCE → TRUTH

THE MOON — “I was full last night.” · THE VILLAIN — “I DIDN’T DO IT.” (×6) · RAY — “People say that, right?”

03 How the Themes Reinforce Each Other

Pairing	Result
Light + Comic	A dark street with a talking lamp is a joke; the lamp is also the only way to read the graffiti on the wall behind it.
Comic + Twist	Every suspect repeats their line after the reveal. The Villain's "I DIDN'T DO IT" suddenly means it in a different tense.
Light + Twist	The Sun Facility is fully lit by your own flashlight — the brightest thing in the game is the evidence that convicts you.

Funny → dark → curious → you point a lamp at your own crime scene → the joke stops being funny

04 Core Mechanic — Light Is the Evidence

Ray records nothing. The game does: notebook entries, clue states, and which of the six suspects have been contradicted.

1. Sweep with the flashlight. Clue text only renders inside the beam, and anything left in the dark cannot be picked up.
2. Question a suspect with a clue in hand. A contradiction flags the notebook and unlocks new dialogue lines.
3. Redirect light — mirrors, floor lamps, wall switches — until a room is bright enough to be searched properly.
4. Connect two clues in the notebook. A correct pairing unlocks the next area; a wrong pairing is just Ray being wrong out loud.

You win by lighting the Sun Control Room yourself, reading the log, and pressing the switch back on. **The tutorial was the last puzzle.**

05 Level Flow & Scope

Level 1 — Dark City: tutorial, movement, flashlight, the first clue. **Level 2 — Suspect Street:** the Moon, the Lamp, the Toaster. **Level 3 — Villain's Lair:** interrogation and light puzzles. **Level 4 — The Sun Facility:** follow the evidence you already own. **Final — The Switch:** the truth, then the tutorial again with new context.

Committed (100 hours): six suspects · clue-reactive branching dialogue · flashlight, lamp and switch routing · clues that render only inside the beam · notebook comparison · 3–4 light puzzles · the Ray twist · cartoon UI. 10–15 minutes.

Stretch (cut first): multiple endings, extra suspects, hidden comedy clues, post-ending replay, alternate conclusions.

06 What Makes This Distinctive

Mystery games hand you a villain. This one hands you a case you solved in the first five minutes, then made you forget.

- The suspects are jokes and the jokes are clues — the funniest line on screen is also the most useful information in it.
- Darkness is a verb — light is the tool, the puzzle type and the mood; nothing here is hidden by design, only by absence of photons.
- The player is the suspect — the twist is not who lied, it is who you are, and you watched yourself do it in the tutorial.

07 Submission Details

Team	Zenitsu
Lead	Ramtej — IndieConnect: ramavathramteja
Member	Loshith Naidu — IndieConnect: loshithnaidu
Engine / genre	Godot 4.7 / GDScript · First-person comedy mystery · General Track, 100-hour jam
Repository	https://github.com/ramavathramteja-web/game-2026/tree/main
Contact	ramavathramteja@gmail.com · loshithnaidu@gmail.com
Status	Script & response bank: docs/THE_MISSING_SUN_SCRIPT.md · submitted at Hour 12